

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

Module title	Dissertation
Module code	COM 752
Module leader	Dr Colin Kuka
Assessment title	Dissertation (100%)
Launch date	Dissertation (August 2025)
Submission deadline	August 2025
Expected date for return of marks and feedback	Feedback can be expected within 3 weeks of the submission date and might be electronic via email or Moodle, written, verbal, or a combination of these.
Module outcomes assessed	1. Critically evaluate the use of research methodologies in the wider context of computing. 2. Compose an independent plan of study that demonstrates research and professionalism in the application of digital technology. 3. Synthesise and disseminate a range of complex information from a variety of sources to reinforce subject specialist practice. 4. Devise and create a data generating artefact as part of a structured research project. 5. Assemble a comprehensive written dissertation that concludes on primary research and relates it to contemporary professional, legal, ethical and social issues.
Assessment weighting	100%
Word count (if relevant)	Dissertation 15000 to 20000 words
Assessment task details - provide a description of the task	
Thesis - Dissertation Development and Proposal Guidelines Prior to commencing the dissertation writing process, candidates are required to undertake the following preparatory steps: 1. Topic Selection: Identify a research topic of personal interest that aligns with the program's scope.	

2. **Original Contribution:** Conduct a comprehensive review of current scholarly literature to ascertain the existing state of knowledge and formulate an original research contribution. This contribution should address a gap or extend existing understanding within the chosen topic.
3. **Preliminary Proposal (3-Slide PowerPoint):** Develop a concise 3-slide PowerPoint presentation outlining the proposed dissertation. This presentation must encompass the following key elements:
 - **Slide 1: Literature Review Summary:** A synopsis of the latest research relevant to the chosen topic, highlighting the identified research gap or area for contribution.
 - **Slide 2: Proposed Methodology:** A detailed description of the research methodology to be employed, including data collection and analysis techniques.
 - **Slide 3: Expected Results and Implications:** A clear articulation of the anticipated research outcomes and their potential implications.

Students must present this PowerPoint to the Module Leader and the Supervisor Allocated

Dissertation Structure Requirements:

The final dissertation document must adhere to the following structural framework:

- **Abstract:** A concise summary of the research, including the problem statement, methodology, key findings, and conclusions.
- **Introduction:** An overview of the research topic, providing context and rationale for the study.
- **Problem Statement:** A clear and concise articulation of the research problem or question being addressed.
- **Objective (Research Questions/Research Hypotheses):** A precise statement of the research objectives, formulated as research questions or testable hypotheses.
- **Methodology:** A detailed description of the research design, data collection procedures, and data analysis techniques.
- **Discussion:** An interpretation of the research findings, relating them to the existing literature and addressing the research questions or hypotheses.

- **Conclusion:** A summary of the key findings, their implications, and recommendations for future research.

Key Considerations:

- The word count of 15,000 to 20,000 words applies to the main body of the dissertation and excludes elements such as the abstract, references, and appendices.
- It is very important to adhere to the institutions guidelines for formatting, and citation.

Submission instructions - What should be the format of the submission? / Where should it be submitted?

Complete your report for each of the tasks in neatly justified Arial or Times New Roman font size of 12 on A4 paper size and collate them for submission in a single .doc or .pdf file not more than 25 pages for all your appendices (all figures and images must be appended to your reports as appendices with clear titles or labels indicating to which tasks, they belong.)

Product based - All codes (i.e., .mlx or .R files) must be uploaded to the designated submission point on Moodle in a single zipped folder. For codes written in R, please ensure that the encoding is generic (e.g., UTF-8). Corrupt files or files that do not load will not be assessed. The onus is on you to check all your files for correctness and accessibility.

Research based – All instrumental for Data Collection (Questionnaire, Framework, Interview question and etc), dataset, or corpus and etc should be submitted.

Your submission must be in a single document (.doc or .pdf) having a title page and a declaration statement. The title must have your full name, student ID number, module title, and date. The declaration must include a statement affirming that you have completed the coursework independently with your name, signature, and date under the statement.

All required work must be submitted, in full and as directed and described, by the due time and date, to achieve marks reflecting its full worth. Work submitted after the due time and date, but within one calendar week, will be capped at 40%. Work more than a week late will not be marked and will be entered as 0%.

All submissions will be via Turnitin Only

All submitted work is expected to observe academic standards in terms of referencing, academic writing, use of language, etc. Failure to adhere to these instructions may result in your work being awarded a lower grade than it would otherwise deserve.

Hints and tips

For all tasks:

Please refer to the lecture notes, lecture videos, and demonstration codes (in Python and R studio).

Marking and moderation

All work is fully marked by the module leader or a team associate. A representative sample of work from each cohort will be second-marked to ensure quality and consistency.

All required work must be submitted, in full and as directed and described, by the due time and date, to achieve marks reflecting its full worth. Work submitted after the due time and date, but within one calendar week, will be capped at 40%. Work more than a week late will not be marked and will be entered as 0%.

Please study the marking criteria provided to fully understand how marks will be awarded for your work.

Please note: Any marks received will be **provisional and subject to change during the moderation process** until formally approved by an Assessment Board

Employability Skills Applied

On successful completion of this module, a student will have had opportunities to demonstrate achievement of the following Employability Skills (note these)

Tick all that apply.

CORE ATTRIBUTES

Engaged	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Creative	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Enterprising	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Ethical	☐

KEY ATTITUDES

Commitment	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Curiosity	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Resilient	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Confidence	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Adaptability	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

PRACTICAL SKILLSETS	
Digital fluency	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Organisation	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Leadership and team working	☐
Critical thinking	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Emotional intelligence	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
Communication	☒ ILOs, 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Evaluation: Dissertation (100%)

Grade Boundaries %	1-29%	30-39%	40 – 49%	50 – 59%	60 – 69%	70 – 79%	80 – 90%	90-100%
Abstract 5%	Unsatisfactory level of abstract.	Minimum level of written abstract.	Satisfactory level of written abstract.	Fairly good level of written abstract.	Good level of written abstract.	Excellent level of written abstract.	Exceptional level of written abstract.	Outstanding level of written abstract.
Introduction 5%	Unsatisfactory explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Minimum explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Satisfactory explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Fairly good explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Good explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Excellent explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Exceptional explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.	Outstanding explanation of introduction/background/setting the scene.
Problem Statement/ Objective (Research Questions/Research Hypothesis) 10%	The purpose of the study is unclear, or the topic has been insufficiently specified. The justifications for topic choice are insufficient. The research question or hypotheses have been insufficiently defined.	The purpose of the study is clear and the justifications for topic choice are adequately explained.	The purpose and problems of the study are clear and justified. The topic has been successfully specified. The study is worthy but unlikely to make a significant contribution to the field.	The research topic is significant for the discipline. The research task and problems are clear and carefully justified.	The study is interesting and significant for the discipline. The topic is exceptionally challenging. The work contributes significantly to the field.	Excellent and interesting and significant for the discipline. The topic is exceptionally challenging. The work contributes significantly to the field.	Exceptional and interesting and significant for the discipline. The topic is exceptionally challenging. The work contributes significantly to the field.	Outstanding and interesting and significant for the discipline. The topic is exceptionally challenging. The work contributes significantly to the field.
Literature Review (with citation) 20%	Unsatisfactory level literature, lack of peer-reviewed publications in the references.	Minimum level The literature is limited, secondary or only partly relevant. Limited use of peer-reviewed publications. Familiarization with the literature is insufficient or superficial and used with little critical evaluation. Definition of concepts is insufficient or their use inconsistent.	Satisfactory level The sources have been chosen in line with the topic, and some credible (e.g. peer-reviewed, case study) publications have also been used as source materials. Sources are subject to some critical evaluation. The essential concepts have been defined. 8 points	Fairly Good level The source material is relevant to the topic, fresh, and the majority of the sources are credible publications. Sources are selected with discrimination. The work demonstrates some source criticism and synthesis. The background theory justifies the purpose and problems of the study. The use of concepts is fluent and consistent.	Good level The source material is based on credible and original publications and is appropriate to the theme of the re-search task. The use of sources demonstrates familiarity with the studied phenomenon. The background theory has a strong, logical connection to the re-search task and problems, as well as to the method choice and	Excellent level The literature is essentially related to the theme of the research task and problems, and it consists of high-level, credible and original publications. Literature is also critically evaluated and analysed with regard to the degree of reliability in the studies and the observations made in them.	Exceptional good level of Literature - The literature is overall related to the theme of the research task and problems, and it consists of high-level, credible and original publications. Literature is also critically evaluated and analysed with regard to the degree of reliability in the studies and the observations made in them.	Outstanding level of literature - The literature is overall related to the theme of the research task and problems, and it consists of high-level, credible and original publications. Literature is also critically evaluated and analysed with regard to the degree of reliability in the studies and the observations made in them.

					methodological solutions			
Research Methods 20%	Unsatisfactory level of research frame and methods in relation to the purpose of the study is weak. The methods have been described inaccurately. Their use is insufficient and inconsistent. Ethical research factors have not been considered or considered superficially.	The suitability of the research frame and methods in relation to the purpose of the study is weak. The methods have been described inaccurately. Their use is insufficient and inconsistent. Ethical research factors have not been considered or considered superficially.	The methods used are basic, and the volume of data is limited in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is basic but sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented superficially.	The methods used are fairly good, and the volume of data is fairly related in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is good and sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented fairly well.	The methods used are good, and the volume of data is related in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is good and sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented well.	The methods used are excellent, and the volume of data is excellent in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is good and sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented excellent.	The methods used are exceptional, and the volume of data is exceptional in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is good and sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented exceptionally well.	The methods used are outstanding, and the volume of data is outstanding in relation to the purpose of the study. The description of methods is good and sufficient. Ethical principles have been presented exceptionally outstanding.
Results and Analysis 20%	Unclear expected results. Not stated	The way of presenting results is limited, and relevant results are not distinguished from irrelevant. Presentation is unclear and unorganized. There are technical limitations in e.g. tables and figures. The interpretation of results is narrow, superficial, and only answers some of the research problems	The expected results provide solutions to research problems, but their presentation is narrow and partly unclear and formulaic.	The expected results could provide a fairly good solutions to research problems.	The expected results could provide a good solution to research problems.	The expected results could provide an excellent level of solution to research problems.	The expected results could provide an exceptional solution to research problems.	The expected results could provide an exceptionally outstanding solution to research problems.
Discussion and Conclusion 15%	Unclear and no discussion	Discussion and conclusions are narrow and superficial. The research questions are not answered. Discussion is not in line with the results. Comparison of the results to previous research data is insufficient. Critical	Discussion is superficial but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to some extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.	Discussion is fairly good but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to a fairly good extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.	Discussion is good but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to a good extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.	Discussion is excellent but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to a excellent extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.	Discussion is excellent but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to a exceptional extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.	Discussion is exceptional but in line with the results. The results have been discussed, to a exceptional extent, in relation to previous literature. The study makes an effort to critically evaluate the results.

		evaluation of the study is missing or superficial						
Reference and Presentation 5%	Failure to provide references will necessitate the resubmission of the entire proposal or dissertation.	Ensure that the format is clear and accurate, aligning with citations and incorporating proper references from reputable sources, including those available in electronic databases, journals, and reliable reference materials.						